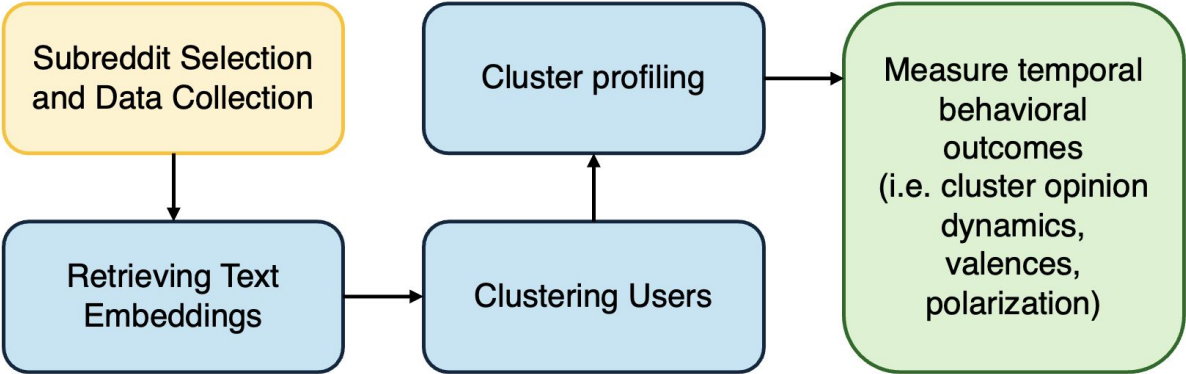


A Framework for Detecting Micro-Communities on Popular Subreddits

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PROJECT OVERVIEW



Heilmeier Questions

What is your approach?

Our analysis begins by identifying a corresponding subreddit (candidate subreddits include: r/movies, r/climatechange, r/uspolitics, r/Futurology, r/cryptocurrency). Following this, we will be using existing models to retrieve vector embeddings of comments and posts for each user. The final stage includes exploratory analysis on identifying clusters and contextualizing groups. A subsequent analysis will be done to study behavioral outcomes (i.e. opinion dynamics) across groups.

What data/compelling evidence do you seek to get?

Finding the presence of micro-communities in larger communities based on different opinions. We also seek to contextualize the clusters and investigate if they align with some defining behavioral characteristics.

How will the effort inform a new start and map to office strategy?

Understanding dynamics within communities have benefits for both the platform and the users. The platform can better recommend content as well as formulate policies that align with consumer usage. For consumers, it helps them identify prevailing opinions within forums and be informed about existence of misinformation/polarization within forums.

Effort Problem Statement / Goals

What problem are you tackling?

Communities on social media platforms provide an avenue for consumers to interact on a shared interest. However, differing opinions among individuals for the same issue present an interesting problem on identifying the existence of micro-communities (community within a community). Current approaches leverage on direct observed relationships (such as friends, interactions) while our approach captures network relationships based on latent features.

What is your main objective/What are you trying to learn?

We aim to establish a framework that leverages large unstructured text data to infer corresponding micro-communities and networks within a given subreddit. In doing so, we are able to uncover latent relationships among users within a community.

Funding / Acquisition Strategy

- Total Cost:
- Duration:
- Agent:
- Performer(s):
- Expected obligation date: